Feast Day Match

A matching game for young children — Ages 4-7 — 2-4 Players — 15 Minutes

Age Range	Players	Play Time	Difficulty
4-7	**2-4**	**15 minutes**	**Easy**

About This Game

Feast Day Match helps young children learn the twelve major feasts of the Coptic Orthodox Church by matching each feast's name to a picture that represents it. As children play, they begin to recognize the rhythm of the Church year — the celebrations that shape our life together.

> **Formation Goal:** Building early love for the rhythm of church life — feasts as encounters with the living Christ.

Components

- **12 Feast Name Cards** — each showing a feast name, date, and brief description
- **12 Feast Image Cards** — each showing a picture representing the feast

Setup

1. Print the card sheets on cardstock.
2. Cut along the card borders. You should have 24 cards total.
3. Shuffle all 24 cards together.
4. Lay the cards face-down in a grid (6 × 4).

How to Play

1. The youngest player goes first.
2. On your turn, flip over any two cards.
3. **Match:** If a feast name card matches its image card, keep the pair and take another turn.
4. **No match:** Flip both cards back face-down. Next player's turn.
5. When all pairs are found, the player with the most pairs wins.

Matching Pairs

- **Nayrouz** — A bright star rising above red flowers
- **Feast of the Cross** — A glowing cross discovered in the earth
- **The Nativity** — A baby in a manger beneath a star
- **Epiphany** — A dove descending over water
- **Palm Sunday** — People waving palm branches
- **The Resurrection** — An empty tomb with light streaming out
- **The Ascension** — A figure rising into the clouds
- **Pentecost** — Tongues of fire on the disciples
- **The Transfiguration** — Brilliant light on a mountain
- **Assumption of St. Mary** — A woman carried upward by angels
- **Feast of the Apostles** — Two men with scrolls going to the nations
- **The Annunciation** — An angel appearing to a young woman

Tips for Parents and Teachers

- Play this game near actual feast days to connect the game to real church experience.
- When a pair is matched, say together: "We celebrate [feast name] because..."
- For very young children, start with just 6 feasts (12 cards).

- Use the Coptic dates to introduce the Coptic calendar: "Did you know we have our own calendar?"

Variants

- **Seasonal play:** Use only the cards for feasts in the current season.
- **Ordering game:** After matching, try to put the feasts in order through the year.
- **Cooperative:** Work together to find all 12 pairs. Count your flips!

> *"This is the day the Lord has made; we will rejoice and be glad in it." — Psalm 118:24*